winning a series in Sri Lanka in 2014. I choose to remember the good days, the great occasions and experiences in many parts of the world. Beyond the results, beyond the matches won and lost, I reflect upon so many golden seasons spent playing cricket alongside so many wonderful people ... wonderful people who became wonderful teammates and eventually wonderful friends.

When Albie and Morné Morkel were named among SA Cricket's five players of the year in 2008, they became the first brothers to receive the award in the same season since Athol and Eric Rowan in 1952. South African cricket has a distinguished history of celebrated brothers: Peter and Graeme Pollock excelled in the 1960s and 70s, Peter and Gary Kirsten thrived in the 1980s and 90s, and the Morkels have illuminated our era.

As far as I can recall, their names were first mentioned in sporting circles in 1996. The Morkels had long been recognised as one of the most prominent families in South African sport, ever since they supplied half of the Springbok rugby team in the 1920s. One branch of the family settled in Vereeniging, where Vat Morkel was an outstanding teacher at a local high school and his sons Albert and Gerard were, respectively, a professional cricketer in the Transvaal Country Districts team and the national discus champion.

The talent was unquestionably in the genes. Albert duly married Mariana, and they produced three sons: Malan, who dismissed Brian Lara while playing for a Gauteng XI in 1998, Albie and Morné.

I met Morné, the youngest brother, first, in an Under-13 match between Transvaal and Northerns at St John's College in Johannesburg. Transvaal batted first and didn't score many. We reached their total reasonably quickly and won the game, but our coach asked if we could continue batting for the rest of our overs.

Since I was scoring freely at the time, I was very eager to carry on, but I saw the tall Transvaal fast bowler was not as happy. He had had enough, seemed close to tears and wanted to go home.